

Author's Craft: Why Did the Writer Do That?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Write all answers in your book. Number each one.

Hook opening Starts mid-action or holds back information, so the reader needs answers.	Show, don't tell Actions and details reveal a feeling instead of naming it.	Punctuation for effect A short sentence hits hard. Dashes set words apart.	Answer frame The writer ___ so that the reader ___.
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Part A: Do Now (5 min, on your own)

Last lesson: figurative language. Name the device and explain its effect.

A1 The thunder grumbled in the distance like an old man woken too early.

A2 The exam hall was a freezer.

Part B: Show, Don't Tell Charades

An actor picks a feeling and acts it for 20 seconds, silently. To score, the class must name the feeling AND two actions that gave it away. Then write one sentence that shows a feeling without naming it; your partner guesses.

1 nervous 2 bored 3 guilty 4 excited 5 jealous 6 exhausted 7 proud 8 suspicious

Part C: Drill

Answer each with the frame: The writer ___ so that the reader ___.

Openings

C1 (a) My name is Josh and I am twelve and I live in a house with my family. (b) Nobody believed me about the thing in the basement. Not until Tuesday.

Which opening hooks the reader better? Why?

C2 By the time the police arrived, it was already too late.

Why does the writer begin the story this way?

Show, don't tell

C3 Kai slammed his bag on the desk, jaw clenched, and refused to look at anyone.

The writer never says Kai is angry. Why not?

C4 (a) Nina was very scared. (b) Nina's breath came in short gasps and she pressed her back against the door.

Which is more effective? Why?

Punctuation for effect

C5 He lifted the lid of the box. Empty.

Why is "Empty." a sentence on its own?

C6 Only one person knew the code—her own brother.

Why does the writer use a dash here?

C7 The sign on the gate read Défense d'entrer—No entry—in faded red paint.

Why are the words "No entry" placed between dashes?

Part D: Exit Ticket (on your own, 2 marks)

D Mum read the letter twice, folded it very carefully, and walked out of the kitchen without a word.

The writer does not tell us how Mum feels. Why is this effective?